

Phase 2: Requirement Analysis

Customer Journey Map

1. Journey Overview

The Customer Journey Map tracks the end-to-end user experience within ComicCraft across five distinct phases: Discovery & Prompting, Configuration & Preference Setting, AI Multi-Model Processing, Sequential Review, and Publication & Export.

2. Multi-Stage Journey Table

Journey Stage	User Goals & Actions	Touchpoint	User Thoughts & Emotions	System Response / Feature	Potential Friction & Mitigations
1. Discovery & Prompting	User visits ComicCraft to create an AI comic. Reads hero tagline and explores story presets.	Homepage (/)	"Can I really make a comic without drawing?" - Curious, hopeful.	Renders atmospheric comic header, clear value proposition, and quick-picker preset chips.	Blank page syndrome. Mitigation: 4 pre-engineered story presets with 1-click auto-fill.
2. Configuration	Fills in Story Prompt, Character Name, Setting, Tone, and Art Style.	Creation Form Card (index.html)	"I want this to feel like a classic comic book." - Creative, engaged.	Form validation highlights required fields and provides responsive select dropdowns.	Complex forms discourage users. Mitigation: Streamlined 5-field form with sensible defaults.
3. Processing	Clicks "GENERATE COMIC STRIP" and waits for AI orchestration.	Loading Overlay	"I hope the story is exciting!" - Anticipatory.	Displays dynamic comic loading overlay with rotating sound effects (POW!, ZAP!, KABOOM!) and progress labels.	Perceived waiting time. Mitigation: Multi-threaded concurrent image generation reduces wait by 5x.
4. Sequential Review	Reviews 5-panel comic sequentially: images, scene description, dialogue, captions, prompt references.	Comic Preview Page (/generate)	"Wow, this looks like an actual comic page!" - Delighted, impressed.	Renders panel cards with speech bubbles, yellow caption boxes, dark narrator blocks, and scene frames.	Disconnected story panels. Mitigation: Sequential prompt binding maintains storyline continuity.
5. Publication & Export	Clicks "Download Your Comic as PDF". Saves the PDF to their local computer.	Download & Export Success Page (/export-success)	"I can print this out and share it with my friends!" - Proud, satisfied.	Downloads timestamped PDF (comic_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.pdf) and redirects to celebratory confirmation page.	Broken download links. Mitigation: Native FastAPI FileResponse attachment stream with fallback links.

3. Key Moments of Truth (MoT)

- Zero-Friction Prompting: Enabling the user to test the platform in under 5 seconds using quick presets.
- The Visual Reveal: First impression of the 5-panel strip with authentic comic speech bubbles and illustrations.
- Offline Artifact Delivery: Holding the completed multi-page PDF document confirms genuine product utility.